represented a similar brain drain that added to the sense of frustration, and fuelled social conservatism and populism among those left behind. The three Baltic states alone are believed to have lost 20% of their 1991 population.[82]

In Yugoslavia during the Communist times we also had another category of emigrants, the so-called guest-workers, who, in the 1970s, began to be attracted to Germany and, to a lesser extent, to Austria, Italy, Switzerland, France and Sweden. Just as some Irish went to the UK, it became customary for some Yugoslavs to travel to Germany for a couple of years to work (as a builder or nurse, for example) and then to return home. Many did so and invested the money they earned in a new house or a small independent business. Yugoslavs were joining a German scheme, called the *Gastarbaiter* programme, which sought to attract workers from Mediterranean countries for the fast-growing German economy, but this suited Tito's Yugoslavia too, as it provided a welcome source of foreign currency for his regime and prevented unemployment. The Yugoslav workers thus became a part of a larger Western European social experiment with migrant workforces that would decades later result in the issue of integration and also at least partly shape the continent's response to the 2015/2016 migrant crisis.

By the late 1960s, Slovenia developed to such an extent that it started to need a foreign workforce itself, above all in construction and services. From the 1970s onwards, buses of workers from Bosnia, Kosovo and other parts of the former Yugoslavia came pouring into Slovenia. (In 1962, the GDP per head in Slovenia was 195% of the Yugoslav average but was only 37% in Kosovo.[83]) They were the Slovenian version of guest-workers or an immigrant workforce, at times facing a degree of xenophobia, and at others positive discrimination against the locals in order to make a case for the official ideology of 'brotherhood and unity'. Lack of interest in learning Slovenian, taking for granted that their Serbian would be understood, was an issue, but many of them settled permanently and integrated. This was one of few immigrant experiences in Eastern Europe.

Slovenia appeared to be moving on despite Communism. Still, the net real incomes in relatively affluent Communist Slovenia only reached 1939 levels again in 1957. Because of the political and economic crisis after the death of Tito in 1980, incomes fell further after 1988 and thus, in 1991,